

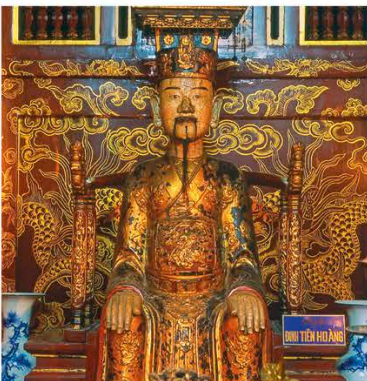


PAGAN KINGDOM

From the 1050s to the 1280s, Pagan, in what is now Myanmar, was the capital of the first Burmese kingdom. It was one of the greatest Buddhist centers in Southeast Asia. Pagan kings built 10,000 Buddhist monuments, of which more than 2,000 still survive today.

KHMER EMPIRE ►

From around the 9th to the 13th centuries, the most powerful kingdom in Southeast Asia was the Khmer Empire. Khmer kings established their capital at Angkor (in present-day Cambodia), where they built Angkor Wat—the largest temple complex in the world. It is decorated with people and scenes from Hindu mythology.



THAI KINGDOMS ▼

After freeing themselves from Khmer rule in the 13th century, the Thai established two kingdoms—Sukhothai in the north and Ayutthaya in the south. Ayutthaya went on to unite present-day Thailand, and became one of the leading regional powers from the 14th to 18th centuries.

Statue of Buddha at Wat Mahathat in Sukhothai Historical Park, Thailand



◀ DAI VIET

China heavily influenced the culture of northern Vietnam. After nearly a thousand years under Chinese rule, it was unified in 968 CE into an empire called Dai Viet by the military leader Đinh Bộ Lĩnh, who became its first emperor. He is shown here wearing regal clothes in the Chinese style.